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Ravichandran Ashwin became the second Indian bowler, after Anil Kumble, to pick up 500 Test wickets when England opener Zak Crawley top-edged a sweep to be caught at leg-slip on the second day of the third Test at the Niranjan Shah Stadium in Rajkot.

Ashwin has consistently proven to be a formidable match-winner for the Indian cricket team, particularly excelling in home matches.

Notably, his effectiveness against left-handed batters has added an extra dimension to his bowling prowess. Of Ashwin's 501 Test wickets, 250 are of left-hand batters. No other bowler has dismissed left-handers as many times. James Anderson is second on the list with 217 wickets against left-handers.

THE HIGHLY SKILLED OFF-SPINNER IS OFTEN EVALUATED WITHIN THE LIMITED SCOPE OF HIS ABILITY TO INFLUENCE MATCHES IN UNFAMILIAR CONDITIONS

A FORMIDABLE MATCH-WINNER

The **all-rounder** serves as both the attacking focal point and the creative hub of the Indian team.

They are the only two bowlers to dismiss left-hand batters 200 times in Tests.

The aspect of Ashwin's career that stands out more than any other is his record at home: 348 wickets in 59 Tests at an average of 21.22. But it would be remiss if we spoke about Ashwin's impact without talking about his bowling partner, Ravindra Jadeja. India's current spin duo has already racked up better numbers than its illustrious predecessors, Anil Kumble and Harbhajan Singh.

In the 52 Tests (before the Ranchi Test) that they have played together, Ashwin and Jadeja have collectively